



2-14-2023 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=S0sNoHxUUqE
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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the meeting to order at approximately [00:01:46](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** President Bishop (absent/in Argentina as noted by roll call), Mr. Heater, Dr. Bales, Mrs. Barnes Griffin, Mr. Irvin, Mr. Lowe, and Mr. Williams. *(Note: Presiding officer conducting roll call identified members present).*
 - **Members Absent:** Bishop (noted as in Argentina).
 - **Presiding Officer:** Noted as President/Chair.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by student guests ([00:01:50](#)), followed by a moment of silence ([00:02:13](#)). Special recognition was given to the Northside Middle School Push-Up Club led by Mr. Williams, who demonstrated push-ups and math drills with students ([00:02:49](#)) and were awarded tickets to an upcoming Ball State basketball game against Kent State ([00:10:31](#)).

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:12:17 Report: South View Elementary School Climate & Operations**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Casey Smitherman (New Principal of Southview Elementary) and accompanying district staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Dr. Smitherman presented updates on building climate, behavior management, attendance initiatives, and academic strategies at Southview Elementary. Key updates included enforcing consistent hallway and restroom schedules, establishing behavior support rooms (such as a reset room and in-school suspension), increasing daily outdoor recess to a minimum of 20 minutes, reopening the cafeteria for student lunches, expanding parental engagement through upcoming events and food pantries, and adjusting Professional Learning Communities (PLCs) to after-school hours. Board members expressed strong support and committed to providing necessary resources.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None during this report.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Information presentation; no formal board vote required.
- **00:46:15 Consent Agenda (Items 5.01 through 5.08, excluding 5.02)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board Leadership / Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Routine consent agenda items reviewed.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:46:43 Personnel Recommendations (Subparts b, c, and d)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Recommendations regarding certified staff at Grissom and support staff resignations.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:47:10 Appointment: Principal at Southview Elementary**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Recommendation regarding Dr. Casey Smitherman to serve as Principal at Southview Elementary.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion carried (Recorded as two opposed).
- **00:47:52 Financial Report**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Durham (Chief Financial Officer).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented January calendar year financial results. Highlights included receipt of the state basic grant (\$3.5 million for the month, projected at \$42.8 million annually), no long-term debt payments in January, a total overall cash balance of \$37.5 million, an Education fund balance of over \$15.6 million at month's end, and a \$50,000 payment toward the state common school loan.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Received and filed.
- **00:49:40 High School Grading Formula Adjustment (Item 6.04)**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Reynolds / Caleb.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Proposed adjustments to the high school grading formula (sequential and concurrent grading options) to align with the Governor's Workforce Cabinet's "Next Level Programs of Study" non-traditional 9-week sequence.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:49:43 High School Curriculum Handbook**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Reynolds and high school counseling/administrative team.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Annual review and update of the high school curriculum handbook, incorporating updated career and technical education (CTE) pathways, relocating Project Lead the Way Biomedical to a standalone high school course, adding a software development pathway, an industrial maintenance electrical pathway, and an applied life skills print shop work-based learning class.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:49:57 Middle School Course of Study Handbook**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Reynolds.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Updated middle school handbook to include the rollout of the dual-language middle school program cohort (offering Global Studies, Spanish social studies/world cultures, and sixth-grade math delivered in Spanish for approximately 25 students).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:40:03 Chelsea Pendergrass**
 - Topic: Budget. Did not appear when called.
- **00:40:34 Christina Dunsmore**
 - Topic: Southview Elementary working conditions, lack of district communication regarding staff transitions, and an appeal for board members to visit the school and engage directly with support staff and teachers to understand building conditions.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Dr. K highlighted upcoming events, including author Troy Cummings visiting schools (coordinated via Ball State University), a comprehensive school counseling grant award from the Department of Education, Titus Waters advancing to state finals in wrestling, and upcoming basketball sectionals.
 - Superintendent noted that future compensation committee meetings will commence to review teacher raises.
- **Adjournment:**

- Motion to adjourn made by Mr. Well, seconded by Watasha. Approved by Voice Vote at approximately 00:58:28.

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